

Ἀρμενίδας

Theban Antiquities and Myths in the Fragments of Armenidas

eul_aid: cna

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Life Armenidas was a Greek historian of the 4th century BCE. No details of his life, including his origin or education, survive.

He is known only from fragments of a single, untitled historical work. The fragments indicate a focus on Boeotian local history and mythology. One, preserved by Plutarch, provides an alternative myth of Narcissus, noting he had a sister who shared his fate and that the spring and flower bear his name. Another fragment references the Boeotian city of Thespieae.

Armenidas represents the genre of lost local Greek historiography. His work was used as a source by later compilers like Plutarch. The variant Narcissus myth he records illustrates the diversity of local traditions against Panhellenic versions, though the extreme fragmentation of his text limits his historical importance.

Works (1)

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